

Jin Saeki Ko

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EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University San Luis Obispo

Bachelor of Science in Microbiology

Expected graduation: May 2027

GPA: 3.73

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Clinical Assistant

Sep 2024–Present

- Support patient intake and clinical workflow at Cal Poly's student health center by rooming patients, collecting vitals, obtaining urine samples, preparing exam rooms, and collaborating with clinic staff to support timely, respectful care for student patients.

Dignity Health Physician Mentorship Program

Jun 2024–Sep 2024

- Shadowed physicians in pediatrics, nephrology, neonatology, cardiology, anesthesiology, and orthopedic surgery for 8 weeks.

RESEARCH

Microbiology Undergraduate Researcher, Yep Lab

Feb 2024–Present

- Investigate [iron acquisition pathways](#) in uropathogenic *Escherichia coli* as potential therapeutic targets for urinary tract infections.
- Study the [role of surfactants in swarming motility](#) using bacterial motility assays.
- Developed [AgarLens](#), a Python-based open-source desktop app using image analysis and a YOLO model to measure agar-plate growth, count colonies, and export annotated images.

Chemistry Undergraduate Researcher, Lehr Lab

Sep 2025–Present

- Developed an [atomic absorption spectroscopy protocol](#) to quantify intracellular iron in isogenic *E. coli* strains.

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Frost Fellow

May 2025–Present

- Awarded \$10,000 annually to support undergraduate research through graduation.
- Received \$9,000 in total summer research funding across two summers for continued microbiology research.

SERVICE

Hospice San Luis Obispo County, In-Home Hospice Volunteer

Oct 2023–Present

- Visit clients biweekly to provide companionship, practical support, and emotional support during the end-of-life process.
- Completed training in supporting older adults and clients with cognitive disorders.

Restorative Partners San Luis Obispo, Juvenile Hall Volunteer

Aug 2024–Present

- Build supportive relationships with youth in juvenile hall through sports, conversation, and restorative justice activities.
- Help share youth artwork anonymously through newsletters distributed to guardians, donors, and volunteers.

LEADERSHIP

ASI University Student Governor

May 2024–Jun 2025

- Represented the student body as one of eight *Associated Students Inc.* governors on the University Union Advisory Board.
- Coauthored the proposal for [Egal Pads on a Roll](#), expanding access to menstrual products in University Union bathrooms.
- Wrote a proposal and installed a battery recycling program supporting sustainable operations in the University Union and Recreation Center; voted on policy for ASI-managed facilities.

Bailey College of Science and Mathematics Ambassador

Nov 2023–Present

- Lead campus tours for prospective students and guardians, sharing academic opportunities, student resources, and the College of Science and Mathematics through university-wide outreach events.

University Committee for Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Nov 2023–Jun 2024

- Coauthored the [Bailey College Student DEI Resources website](#) to share inclusive funding, research, teaching, academic, and volunteering opportunities with the student body.
- Worked with faculty on Academic Senate initiatives addressing policies and practices that create barriers to student success.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

- American Society for Microbiology [Jun 2025](#)
- CSU BIOTECH Symposium [Jan 2026](#)
- West Coast Biological Sciences Undergraduate Research Conference [Apr 2025](#)
- BCSM Student Research Conference [May 2024, May 2025, May 2026](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Department of Chemistry and Biochemistry Learning Assistant

Jan 2024–Jun 2024

- Worked with faculty to facilitate student discussion and problem solving in a college classroom.
- Completed training in student-centered teaching and classroom facilitation.